

Rep. Tom Emmer on The Chris Stigall Show

Salem Podcast Network

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****CHRIS:**

** from Minnesota's 6th congressional district. Congressman, good morning, sir.

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

** Good morning, Chris.

****CHRIS:**

** Powerful stuff, and you were mad as a wet hornet when we talked on Capitol Hill a few weeks ago about this, before you ever had your governor and attorney general in front of you. Can you tell folks who might not have seen it how things went and what you learned?

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

** Well, first off, when we talked a few weeks ago, yeah, I was mad. I'm a Minnesotan, Chris, and I'm proud of my state. And when we are on the front page of a national news story about fraud in public programs, I mean, billions of dollars of fraud. We had originally just been told we had a \$250 million largest pandemic fraud case in the country. But since then, we've had attorneys in the U.S. Attorney's Office who have now left. U.S. Attorney Joe Thompson said the fraud could be as high as \$9 billion, Chris. So we finally had an opportunity to talk with Governor Walz and our Attorney General Keith Ellison, as you mentioned a couple days ago. And, you know, I think after the questioning and the bombshell report that was released after I had a chance to examine Governor Walz and Keith Ellison, one thing is becoming clear. Tim Walz, definitely incompetent. Not competent to run a multibillion-dollar business called the state of Minnesota's government. Clearly not competent. There's a question that's starting to develop as to when he actually knew and what he did or didn't do. And that may end up by putting him right in the crosshairs as a corrupt politician that needs to be held accountable. Keith Ellison, on the other hand, clearly he's already been, in my mind, indicted in the court of public opinion as a corrupt public official. The two questions that were most important to me is when did you know about this and what did you do about it? Neither one of them wanted to answer my questions. Keith, at one point when I mentioned that the governor thinks there's a crime ring working in the state of Minnesota and it's been doing this for years, I asked Keith if he's aware, as the top law enforcement, top cop in Minnesota of this crime ring, and he stumbled. He wasn't able to answer. You know why? Because I think he's part of it. He tells us that he didn't know anything about the Feeding Our Future fraud, and yet we have a 54-minute audio tape in December of 2021, where he is literally telling the Somali fraudsters involved with the Feeding Our Future theft. He's telling them that day that he's going to step in and he's going to take care of the Department of Education and any of this scrutiny that they want to do on these programs. And you know what he plays. He plays the race card. He plays the xenophobia card. He plays the Islamophobe card. Well, guess what we find out from the report issued by the Oversight Committee, Jamie Comer's Oversight Committee, after that hearing had started. We found out that according to the assistant commissioner of the Department of Education at the time, that both Tim Walls and Keith Ellison were advised by their office of the fraud and the illegitimacy of the Feeding Our Future group

in April of 2020. Chris, that's a year and a half before Keith Ellison is making promises to these guys. And then, as you know, a week or two after he made those promises in December of 2021, they happened to contribute five-figure amounts to his campaign for attorney general and to his son's campaign for the Minneapolis City Council. And it was about a month later that the FBI and the Department of Education of Minnesota, the FBI issued warrants that Keith Ellison never would have issued. And they acknowledged there had been a long ongoing investigation into this fraud. I think it looks pretty damn. It looks bad for Keith Ellison. And if this is confirmed, Chris, that guy should be disbarred and he should go to jail.

****CHRIS:**

** That was my next question, Congressman Tom Emmer of Minnesota's 6th Congressional District, talking about this massive multibillion-dollar fraud. You have these two individuals in front of you. Maybe you're willing to say Walls is just a bad leader who's sort of a buffoon. Ellison, you think, is almost certainly criminally involved here? And if so, do you think Pam – is Pam Bondi looking into this? I think she said she has. In other words, this shouldn't just go away in the news cycle. I think Dr. Oz has said they're not going to look at similar fraud in New York. We assume this is not the only place it's happening in your state of Minnesota. But next steps here. We shouldn't let this drop. This should be a conversation as we head toward the fall, should it not?

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

** It should and it will, Chris. But let's put in context the difference here between Republicans, who are actually interested in eliminating fraud, and Democrats. If you look at that report, some 50 pages, I think they interviewed under oath, took statements under oath, from nine former Minnesota state government officials that worked in the Walls administration, including the assistant commissioner of education, as I told you. If you take a look at the questioning done by the Republican staff, it's just under 40 hours that they spent with these individuals. About three hours, Chris. They don't care.

****CHRIS:**

** By the way, could I just say, to be accurate, there were Minnesota Democrats who had been trying to sound the alarm on this fraud. There were some Democrats who said, don't pin the blame on us. Walls knew, and we were telling him, and he wasn't acting. Is that accurate or no?

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

** Yes, it is. And what you have in Minnesota, as we're starting to find out, you have a very vindictive governor and a very vindictive administration. I mean, these whistleblowers that are starting to come forward, talking, for instance, to the oversight committee staff under oath. I think you asked me next steps. I think our U.S. attorney in Minnesota should commence a grand jury so that these people can come in and testify under oath without public attention, because what happens is the Tim Walls Tribune doxes them, will put their names out on the street so that people who are connected to Tim Walls and Keith Ellison, people who I suspect have a financial interest in this corruption, will go after them because they have said, off the record, this is the next piece that I think has to be established. They have said they were not only ignored, but they were retaliated against, and they were retaliated against with things like, you will never have a job in Minnesota again. Your family will have a tough time finding employment in Minnesota. You are risking your health care benefits and your retirement benefits. These threats, I'm sure that Democrats that want to do the right thing get the same type of threats. You don't try to take on this corrupt administration, otherwise it will squash you. So yes, there are and were Democrats, but I want you to think about this and your listeners. So we keep talking about the \$250 billion Feeding Our Future scandal, right? Largest pandemic fraud case in the country. The acting U.S. Attorney General last summer, Joe Thompson, last summer or fall, did a press conference where he told us all the fraud

could be as much as \$9 billion. Recently, Joe and several other lawyers who had been in that office for a while left the office claiming they resigned, claiming they were being pressured to investigate the tragic death of Renee Good, her partner. First off, anybody who's listening, if you practice law, you should understand the lawyers don't investigate. The FBI investigates, officers investigate. They put the evidence together. They turn it over to the U.S. attorney who then evaluates whether the evidence rises to the level of a criminal indictment. This guy is not real in my mind because here's the other thing that bothers me. If you're telling us all there's \$9 billion in fraud, why were you only prosecuting \$250 million? By the way, that \$250 million, Joe Thompson and company indicted 96 people, 85 of them Somalis. They convicted 60. You know what was missing, Chris? There was not one public official that was implicated. Look, Tim Walz, I said he's definitely incompetent. You can see that. If, in fact, Tim Walz knew and shows not to do something about it and or was aggressively retaliating against people whistleblowers. I'm going to tell you, he he should be out of office yesterday and he should go to jail as well. I'll tell you, he clearly knows the jig was up because he decided he wasn't going to run again. I think he knew he was headed for some troubled waters in this investigation.

****CHRIS:**

** I have like 30 seconds, Congressman Emmer. Not even really. How's how the prospects for the fall look for the House right now?

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

** Look, I'm still very bullish. People out there should not the hand ringers in the bed wetter should relax. The media does these surveys and puts them up and they say, hey, today, if the election were today, Democrats would have a slight. You know what, Chris? They have to have content. They create these car wrecks to have people talk about something. We're going to stick the landing next fall. We got the best map. The economy starting to rev up under Donald J. Trump. You watch. We're going to be successful.

****CHRIS:**

** Congressman Tom Emmer of Minnesota six. Thank you, sir. Have a great weekend morning.

This transcript was independently produced by MN-06 Watch for accountability and archival purposes.

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